

29.7 KEY LANGUAGE “REALLY,” “FAIRLY,” AND “PRETTY”

A few adverbs can be used with both gradable and non-gradable adjectives. They are “really” (meaning “very much”), and “pretty” and “fairly” (both meaning “quite a lot but not very”).

TIP

Note that “fairly” can have a negative connotation and so is not normally used to suggest something is very good or necessary.

What you need is a **really** { **good**
brilliant } idea.

Gradable
Non-gradable



You need to be **fairly** { **confident**
certain } it works.

Inventing a new product is **pretty** { **difficult**
impossible }.



29.8 LISTEN TO THE AUDIO AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS



Two business partners, James and Maria, have just watched several presentations from product developers. They are discussing which products to invest in.

What did James think of the presentations?

- Liked them a lot** ☒
- Hated them** ☐
- Liked them a little** ☐

1 What did Maria think about how the smartwatch looked?

- Liked it a lot** ☐
- Hated it** ☐
- Liked it a little** ☐

2 What did they both think about the smartwatch functionality?

- Really good** ☐
- Really bad** ☐
- Not very good** ☐

3 What did they think about the cardboard coffee capsules idea?

- Liked it a lot** ☐
- Hated it** ☐
- Liked it a little** ☐

4 What did Maria think about how the coffee machine looked?

- Liked it a lot** ☐
- Hated it** ☐
- Didn't like it very much** ☐

5 What did James think of the air freshener?

- Liked it a lot** ☐
- Hated it** ☐
- Didn't like it very much** ☐